

PREFACE

This document was crafted with input from over 175 youth representing over 100 different youth organizations and 40 U.S. States through a democratic process that included thorough research, debate, and extensive peer review. Various recommendations in this document reflect existing policy, which is linked accordingly in the appropriate sections. The numbers used to label the demands and sub-actions, as well as any bolding and italicization, have been included to improve legibility and do not imply hierarchy between any of the demands. For more information about LCOY USA or this statement, please visit lcoyusa.com or reach out to secretariat@lcoyusa.com.

WHAT IS LCOY USA?

The Local Conference of Youth (LCOY) USA is the United State's official UN-endorsed national youth climate conference. As an organizing body under YOUNGO, the Children and Youth Constituency of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC), LCOY USA is a youth-led initiative that culminates in an annual conference where delegates come together to craft the National Youth Statement (NYS) on Climate. LCOY represents a national version of the international Conference of Youth (COY), which takes place immediately before the Conference of Parties (COP), the annual UN Climate Change Conference.

LCOY aims to ensure young people are empowered and trained to raise their voices in national and international climate policy decision-making spaces. The Conference also seeks to reduce fragmentation and enhance coordination across the U.S. climate movement by bringing together youth representatives from diverse communities and organizations nationwide.

From August 1st-3rd, 2025, at the University of Miami in Miami, Florida, LCOY USA convened over 150 young people (12-35 years old) from across the country, carefully selected for their leadership in the climate movement. Delegates participated in educational panels, negotiation trainings, and policy workshops before engaging in deliberative dialogue to create the 4th National Youth Statement on Climate for the United States of America.